

HIGH DUNES

Vast sand dunes collect at the base of the Andean foothills. One, called Cerro Medanos, rises as high as 1,800 ft (550 m).



△ PENITENTES

Snow rarely melts in the Atacama. Instead, it forms clusters of jagged, ice-encrusted penitentes, named after the spiky hats of Spanish penitents.

▷ CAPTIVE CLOUDS

The Pacific's Humboldt Current pushes cold water toward the ocean's surface, creating fog banks. When trapped near the coast, these bring moisture ashore.

